

# Wheeled Troop Carriers (cont.)

Many 21st-century designs can carry a range of different weapons, from machine guns attached to remote weapon stations, to turrets armed with cannon that are usually found on Infantry Fighting Vehicles. Such options have made these wheeled APCs even more popular. However, such improvements in firepower and protection have led to significant increase in their height and weight, with some vehicles approaching 33 tons (30 tonnes). This makes them more prominent targets and harder to move by air.



△ Eagle IV

Date 2003 Country Switzerland

Weight 7.7 tons (7 tonnes)

Engine Cummins ISB 6.7 E3 diesel, 245 hp

Main armament Varies

The Eagle I, II, and III were based on the HMMWV chassis, whereas the Eagle IV and V use the DURO III truck as its basis, giving it a larger payload. The vehicle is used for reconnaissance, patrol, command, and as an ambulance. More than 750 Eagle IV and Vs have been built for Denmark, Germany, and Switzerland.



Modular design allows different turrets to be mounted

Hydraulic suspension on each wheel

△ Patria AMV

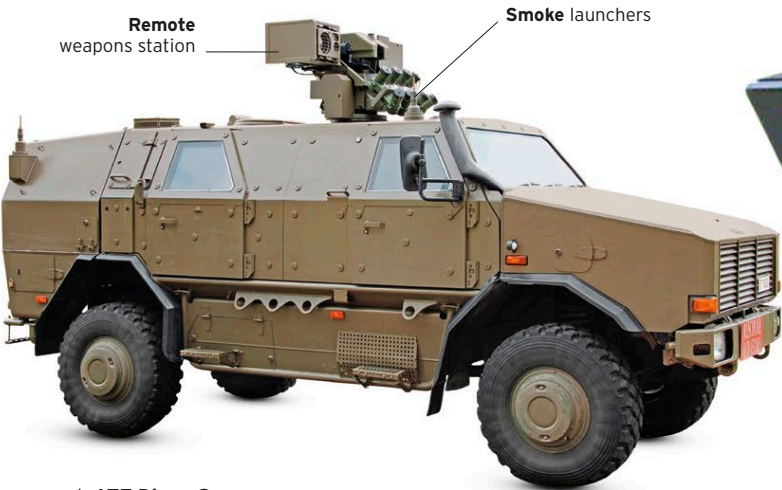
Date 2004 Country Finland

Weight 24.3 tons (22 tonnes)

Engine Scania DC13 diesel, 483 hp

Main armament .50 Browning M2 machine gun

The Patria AMV is available with a wide variety of engines, transmissions, weapons stations, and role-specific equipment. Depending on the turret attached, up to 10 infantrymen can be carried. More than 1,500 AMVs have been sold to seven countries. Poland has the largest fleet and has deployed the Rosomak, as they named it, to Afghanistan.



Remote weapons station

Smoke launchers

△ ATF Dingo 2

Date 2005 Country Germany

Weight 13.8 tons (12.5 tonnes)

Engine Mercedes-Benz OM 924 LA diesel, 222 hp

Main armament Varies

The Dingo is based on the Unimog truck chassis, equipped with an armored hull and underbody mine protection. It has an eight-man crew. Six countries operate the Dingo 2 in roles such as NBC reconnaissance, medical evacuation, patrol, and battlefield surveillance. It has been deployed in the Balkans, Lebanon, and Afghanistan.

▷ VBCI

Date 2008 Country France

Weight 31.9 tons (29 tonnes)

Engine Volvo diesel, 550 hp

Main armament 25 mm GIAT M811 cannon

Unusually for a wheeled vehicle, the VBCI was designed for use as an IFV rather than an APC. It has a three-man crew and carries up to nine infantrymen. France operates 630, of which 110 are command posts. The VBCI has been deployed in Lebanon, Afghanistan, and Mali, where its stabilized cannon proved highly effective.



25 mm GIAT M811 cannon

Crew compartment